

Estimating Nonlinear Insulin-Glucose Dynamics in Critically-ill Patients

Markus Mulvihill

KTH Royal Institute of Technology

August 7th, 2026



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Thesis Presentation

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2. Examiner - Ragnar Thobaben
3. Opponent - Divyayan Day

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 - The Fundamental Problem Addressed
 - Previous Work
- 2 Results and Contributions
 - Main Results
 - Key Ideas Behind Implementation
- 3 Summary
 - Takeaways
 - Further Reading

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- 1 Patients suffering from critical illnesses are subjected to metabolic changes from acute stress

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└ Stress Hyperglycaemia in ICU Patients

Patients suffering from critical illnesses are subjected to metabolic changes from acute stress

1. Inflammatory response secretes stress hormones
2. Acute myocardial infarction, sepsis, stroke

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Stress Hyperglycaemia in ICU Patients

- 1 Patients suffering from critical illnesses are subjected to metabolic changes from acute stress
- 2 Instances of stress-induced hyperglycaemia have been identified to accompany the onset of mortality

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- 2 Instances of stress-induced hyperglycaemia have been identified to accompany the onset of **mortality**
- 3 Tightly maintaining glycaemic levels in ranges 4 mmol/L to 6 mmol/L reduced mortalities by 50% (Berghe et al. 2001)

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Limitations of Intensive Insulin Therapy

- 1 Solely utilizing insulin infusions to tightly control blood glucose struggles to address patient variability

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└ Limitations of Intensive Insulin Therapy

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Limitations of Intensive Insulin Therapy

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- 2 Poor patient adaptability additionally results in cases of hypoglycaemia and high glycaemic variation

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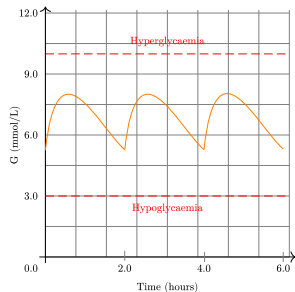


Figure: Blood Glucose Example

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Limitations of Intensive Insulin Therapy

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Figure: Blood Glucose Example

1. Infrequent measurements, not considering nutrition, and not complex to monitor dynamics changes in patient health
2. A patient with exogenous insulin that exponentially decreases

- 1 Mathematical formulations of pancreas function can provide additional insight into glycaemic levels and endogenous insulin production

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Role of Model-based Glycaemic Control

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- 2 Consequently, physiological models better capture patients' insulin-glucose dynamics to sustain glycaemic ranges

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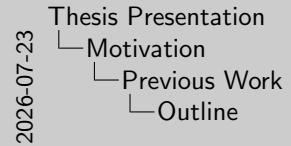
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└ Role of Model-based Glycaemic Control

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1. Better method than IIT to be specific

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Intensive Control Insulin-Nutrition-Glucose (ICING) model

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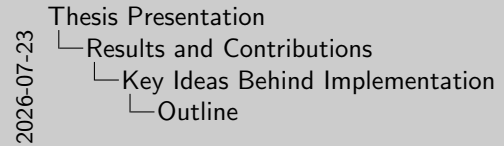
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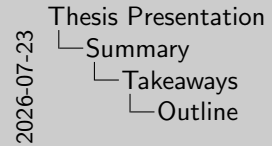
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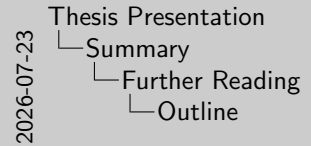
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 Berghe, Greet Van den et al. (Nov. 2001). “Intensive Insulin Therapy in Critically Ill Patients”. In: DOI: 10.1056/NEJMoa011300.

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